

John Thomas

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WORK EXPERIENCE

East Tennessee State University

2024-2026

Graduate Associate

Johnson City, TN

- Lead undergraduate students through the principles of animation, introducing Autodesk Maya, animation workflows, and CGI to students, preparing them for the rest of the curriculum.
- Develop new, up-to-date curriculum to not only make the topics more approachable for the current generation of undergraduate students but also to keep up with the ever-changing field.

Panic Association

2025

Director | Writer | Visual Effects

Johnson City, TN

- Panic Association is an award-winning anthology short film portraying the panic cycle from the mental perspective of a person with dissociative identity disorder. Each part shows a new personality and a new phase of panic as the protagonist retreats deeper into the mind.
- This film was officially selected by Indie Short Fest
- For this film, I helped write and edit the scripts as well as direct parts three and four. For part four, I also rigged a character made by someone on the team and animated it to fit into the footage we had already taken. I then helped with compositing the character into the film.

Character XYZ

2023

Character Rigging artist | Character Animator

Remote

- I was hired to quickly rig and animate characters of various types to be usable as generic game assets that could be streamed to developers. I rigged an anime-style character and created roughly 100 animations that were then exported as GLB files and sent to the rest of the pipeline.

Idtech

2020-2021/ 2023

Online Private Instructor

Remote

- Create and execute lesson plans on certified topics, such as modelling in Maya or Blender and game design in Unreal Engine 4. Provide a healthy and constructive learning space that is engaging to the students and helps them accomplish their goals.

EDUCATION

East Tennessee State University

August, 2022

Bachelor of Science, Digital Media: Animation

Johnson City, TN

- Fine And Performing Arts Honours College; Dean's List
- Minor in Computer Science

East Tennessee State University

August, 2026

Master of Fine Arts, Digital Media: Technical Animation
City, TN

Johnson

SKILLS & INTERESTS

- **Technologies:**
 - Software: Autodesk Maya; Blender; SideFx Houdini; Unreal Engine 5
 - Languages: Python; Hou.py; Bpy.py; MayaPy; Pymel; Mel; C#; Java; C++
- **Skills:** Character Rigging; Keyframe Animation; Layered Animation; Pipeline integration; Pipeline creation; Addon Development; Animation Blueprints
- **Interests:** Programing; Skateboarding; Modeling; Video editing, Movies and Games; Puzzles